

PART 2

How machine collaboration works

A research workspace, a source library, and ways to check what we write.

What role should human cognition play?

Automate

Hand off routine work.

Efficiency is the goal.

Rename files.

Format references.

Track project tasks.

Protect

Do the cognitive work.

Learning is the goal.

Read a difficult argument.

Defend an interpretation.

Collaborate

Work with the machine.

Extend what we can do.

Build a source library.

Compare a draft claim with its evidence.

The same task can change modes when the learning objective changes.

A workspace the researcher can inspect

Researcher

Sets the question
and boundaries.

Reviews evidence.

Decides what to
accept.

directs



proposes



Agent

A model using tools
to read, run, and edit
project files.

guide



guide



reads · writes · runs

Project instructions

Rules and context.

Reusable skills

Procedures for recurring
work.

Persistent project files

Originals and source text · bibliography · code and drafts
Decisions and review records

The conversation can end. The evidence and decisions remain available for inspection.

Build a library that claims can be checked against

Original source

Keep the PDF.
Record its origin.
sources/og/

➔ Converted text

Check the text.
Keep its wording.
sources/md/

➔ Bibliography link

Link a citation key
to source files.
references.bib

➔ Claim checking

Compare a draft
claim with a passage.
Record the result.

↓ summarize, with source links

Derived notes

Summaries and synthesis are working interpretations.
Return to the source text and original when checking a claim.

The reference existed. The claim needed revision.

Draft claim

Before revision

“studies of unilateral policymaking similarly show that citizens penalize executive action relative to legislative action”

Cited together: Reeves & Rogowski (2016); Christenson & Kriner (2017). Excerpt.

Source passage

C&K (2017)

Abstract

“Americans do not instinctively reject unilateral action as a threat to our system of checks and balances”

The abstract instead emphasizes partisan and policy agreement.

Revision

27 August 2026

“judging particular unilateral acts largely by whether they agree with them”

Now attached to Christenson & Kriner alone. Historical manuscript diff: 75366c6.

The source changed the claim. The researcher remained responsible for the revision.